

Term Project – User Guide

HandwerkerKasse – User Guide

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Module: Introduction to Database Management Systems · THGA Bochum

Who this guide is for: anyone using HandwerkerKasse in their daily work – no technical knowledge needed.

1 What is HandwerkerKasse?

HandwerkerKasse is a simple app for craft businesses. It helps you keep track of your customers, your jobs, the materials you use, and the invoices you send. The best part: it automatically tells you whether a job earned you money or cost you money – no calculator needed.

2 Getting started

The app needs to be installed once on your computer. This is normally done for you by whoever set up the system. If you need to do it yourself, open a terminal and type:

```
sudo apt install ./handwerkerkasse.deb
```

After that, you can open HandwerkerKasse like any other program: search for it in your applications menu, or type `handwerkerkasse` in a terminal.

3 Step 1: Connect to the server

When you open the app, you will see the connection screen shown in Figure 1. You need to fill in two things, which you get from whoever set up your system:

- **API URL** – the address of your server. If everything runs on your own computer, this is usually `http://127.0.0.1:8000`.
- **X-API-Key** – think of this like a password that lets you make changes (add customers, jobs, etc.).

Then click **Connect**. If it doesn't work, double-check the address and make sure the server is switched on.

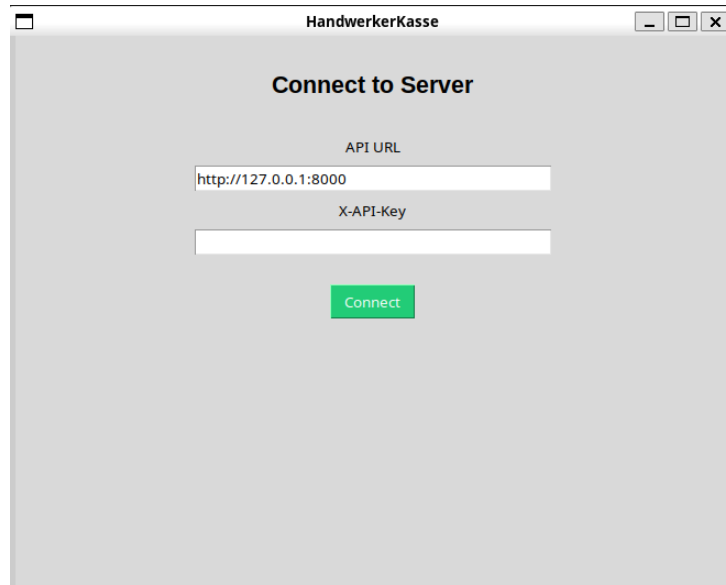


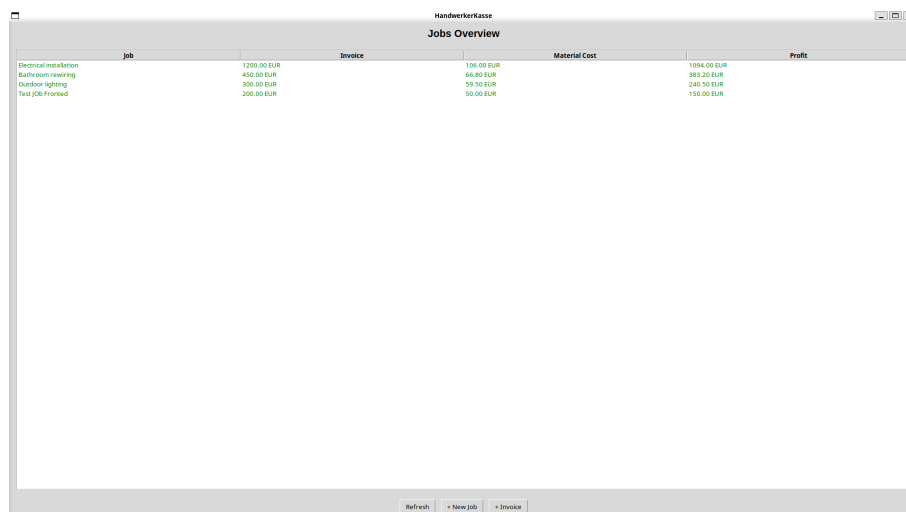
Abbildung 1: The first screen you see when opening the app

4 Step 2: See all your jobs at a glance

This is the main screen, shown in Figure 2 – the one you will use most. It shows every job you have, and next to it how much you billed the customer, how much the materials cost, and what's left over: your profit.

Green means the job made you money. **Red** means it cost you more than you earned.

Use **Refresh** to update the list. Use **+ New Job** or **+ Invoice** to add something new.



Job	Invoice	Material Cost	Profit
Electrical installation	1200.00 EUR	100.00 EUR	1094.00 EUR
Bathroom rewiring	450.00 EUR	66.80 EUR	383.20 EUR
Outdoor lighting	300.00 EUR	50.50 EUR	249.50 EUR
Tree job (removed)	200.00 EUR	50.00 EUR	150.00 EUR

Abbildung 2: Your jobs, with profit shown automatically

5 Step 3: Add a new job

When you start a new job, add it here, as shown in Figure 3:

1. Type in the **customer's ID number**.

2. Give the job a short **name**, e.g. “New bathroom wiring”.
3. Enter the **date**.
4. Click **Save Job**. The app will show you the job’s ID number – keep it in mind, you’ll need it in the next step.

Once the job is saved, list the materials you used for it, at the bottom of the same screen:

1. Enter the **job’s ID number**.
2. Enter the **material’s ID number**.
3. Enter **how much of it** you used.
4. Click **Add Material**.

Repeat this for every material you used on the job.

The screenshot displays the 'HandwerkerKasse' web application interface. It features two main sections: 'New Job' and 'Add Material to Job'. The 'New Job' section includes input fields for 'Customer ID', 'Title', and 'Date (YYYY-MM-DD)' (with the value '2026-08-02' entered), followed by a green 'Save Job' button. The 'Add Material to Job' section includes input fields for 'Job ID', 'Material ID', and 'Quantity', followed by 'Add Material' and 'Back to Overview' buttons.

HandwerkerKasse

New Job

Customer ID:

Title:

Date (YYYY-MM-DD):

Save Job

Add Material to Job

Job ID:

Material ID:

Quantity:

Add Material

Back to Overview

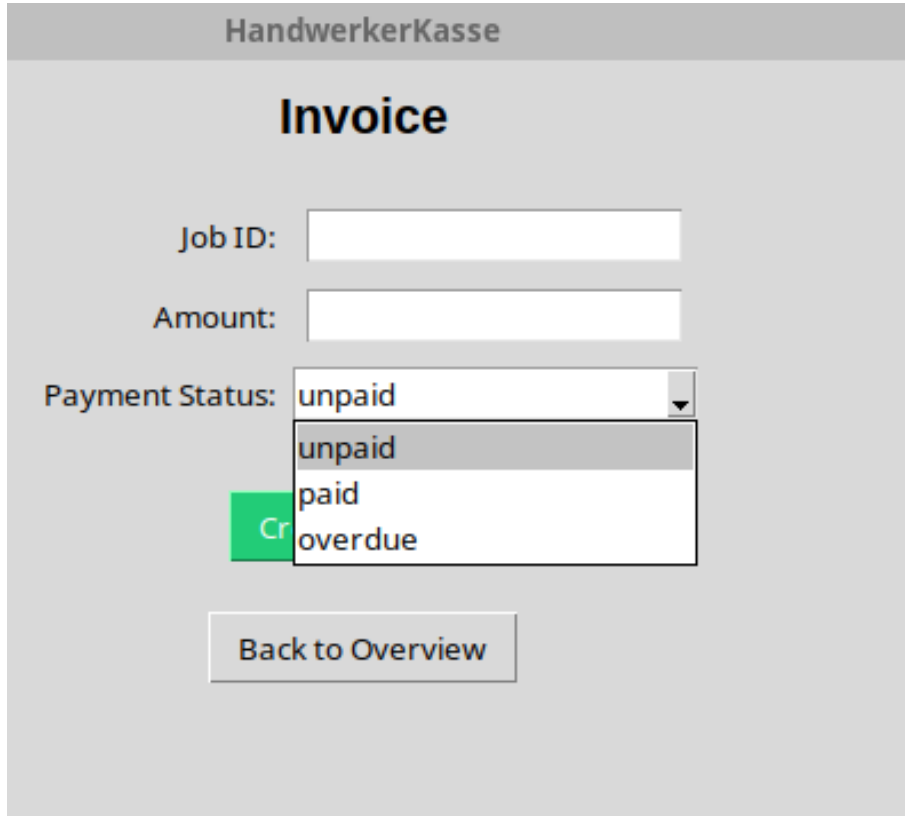
Abbildung 3: Adding a job and the materials used

6 Step 4: Send the invoice

Once the job is done, create the invoice, as shown in Figure 4:

1. Enter the **job's ID number**.
2. Enter the **amount** you're billing the customer.
3. Choose whether it's **unpaid**, **paid**, or **overdue**.
4. Click **Create Invoice**.

You'll be taken straight back to the overview – and now you'll see the profit for that job, calculated automatically.



The screenshot shows a web form titled "HandwerkerKasse" with a sub-header "Invoice". The form contains three input fields: "Job ID:", "Amount:", and "Payment Status:". The "Payment Status:" dropdown menu is open, showing three options: "unpaid", "paid", and "overdue". A green button labeled "Create" is positioned to the left of the dropdown menu. Below the form fields is a button labeled "Back to Overview".

Abbildung 4: Creating an invoice

7 How is the profit calculated?

It's simple: what the customer paid you, minus what you spent on materials.

$$\text{What you earned} - \text{What the materials cost} = \text{Your profit}$$

If that number is positive, you made money on the job (shown in green). If it's negative, the materials cost more than you charged (shown in red) – a sign to adjust your pricing next time.

8 Something not working?

- **Can't connect at startup:** check the server address is correct, and that the server is running.
- **An action fails with an error:** make sure the customer, job or material ID you typed actually exists, and that your X-API-Key is correct.
- **No profit shown for a job:** the job needs an invoice first. Just add one following Step 4.

9 Frequently asked questions

Can I edit a job after I've created it?

Not directly in the current version – once a job is saved, its details cannot be changed from the app. If you made a mistake, create a new job with the correct information. Editing existing jobs may be added in a future version.

What happens if I enter a customer ID that doesn't exist?

The app will show an error message and the job will not be created. Make sure you use the correct customer ID – you can check existing customers by asking whoever manages your customer list, or by checking a previous invoice.

Do I see jobs that don't have an invoice yet?

Yes – all jobs appear in the overview. However, a job only shows a profit value once an invoice has been created for it. Until then, that job simply won't show up in the profit calculation.

Can several people use the app at the same time?

Yes, as long as everyone connects to the same server using the same API URL and key. Everyone will see the same up-to-date list of jobs.

What if I forget the X-API-Key?

Ask whoever set up your system – they can look it up or create a new one for you. The key is not something you need to remember by heart; it can be copied and pasted when connecting.

Is my data safe if I close the app?

Yes. All your data (customers, jobs, materials, invoices) is stored on the server, not on your computer. Closing the app does not delete anything – simply reopen it and reconnect to see your data again.